Evaluating Agents Reflection

Working through agent evaluation I found that a correct final response in no way proves the agent has behaved correctly. You can in fact evaluate the trajectory (the sequence of tool calls and the arguments passed to those calls) in parallel with the response to expose that kind of failure.

For my own learning and development, the single most important thing I've learned is that evaluation should be part of the design process rather than something you do at the end. In the secure agent work that we do, tool ordering and policy compliance (least privilege, refusing to do anything irreversible without confirmation, refusing to execute an instruction that has been injected via the output of a tool) all have to be written up as explicit automated test cases with deterministic trajectory checks rather than left to the judgement of a human.

That discipline has allowed us to make very specific assertions, such as "that agent never calls the payment tool prior to identity verification," and substantiate them with evidence. That's what you need in a trustworthy, auditable agent system.